Meet our Team



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OUR COMBINED STRENGTHS

- Our team brings together creative, technical, and diverse cultural strengths.
- We combine design, technology, and diverse perspectives to work as one multidisciplinary team.
- Our strength lies in blending creative thinking, technical skills, and diverse backgrounds.

DOMAIN STATEMENT

Enhancing language learning & communication in the workplace through **mutual learning** between **co-workers of different language proficiences.**

Domain

LANGUAGE LEARNING FOR WORK PROFICIENCY

In workplaces, language is typically used before it's fully learned in meetings, e.g. work hangouts and orders.

As workplaces get more diverse, workers of different proficiencies have to work together so learning occurs through interaction than study.

SOCIAL

- Articulation work
- conversation
- interaction
- mutual learning

MOBILE

- context-specific
- context-aware
- location-aware

QUESTION

How might we support co-workers of different language proficiencies in moments where communication happens, so speaking up feels low-risk and both sides learn from it?

Problem Space

WORKPLACE HAS MANY LEARNING OPPORTUNITIES BUT SOCIAL COST IS HIGH

Workers who don't understand something often stay silent rather than ask, so the moment passes and the misunderstandings may lead to consequences. Meanwhile, language apps train people alone, mostly for non-work related situations let alone jargon.

RESEARCH

- **Learning at work needs interaction and support** (Nordic workplace language review, CIP Copenhagen, C17)
- **Workers lack confidence to ask questions, so confusion is unreported of fear of consequences** (C17)
- **Non-judgmental, learner-paced practice raised engagement and proficiency where teacher-led instruction did not** (HRI 2025 robot language learning study)
- **Most AI language learning research doesn't focus on workplaces** (AI in Language Learning: 20-Year Scoping Review, 2026)

Prior Attempts: Three Concept Domains

Initial concepts and supporting research for each domain explored

1

Smart Dressing with AI for Everyday Life

INITIAL CONCEPTS

- Instagram-style app for sharing/tagging daily outfits (#OOTD)
- Digital closet: AI matches & generates outfits from photos
- Supports users running late, neurodivergent, colour-blind, or busy 9-5

RESEARCH

- Grounded in team's own fashion-enthusiast experience
- Chérie: AI outfit assistant + 3D virtual wardrobe (ACM)
- AI wardrobe donation/exchange platform study (ACM)

WEAKNESS

- Too similar to existing apps (Stylebook, Whering) with no clear differentiator or monetisation plan
- Research is mostly personal opinion, not user-validated

2

Smart Dressing with AI for Events

INITIAL CONCEPTS

- Event-based outfit inspiration, merch & organiser info
- AI-curated OOTD ideas via hashtags & keyword search
- AU-focused: music events & related fashion trends

RESEARCH

- AU 18–34s drive $500B+ fashion spend, favour reselling items
- ~50% of Aussies attended live music in past 12 months
- Cost is main barrier despite rising arts/leisure spend

WEAKNESS

- Niche audience (AU music-event goers) that itself says cost is a barrier so it’s a weak business case
- Heavy overlap with Domain 1; unclear if it's a separate app or just a feature

3

Language Learning for Work

INITIAL CONCEPTS

- Real-time, context-aware phrase coaching before meetings
- Buddy system + workplace simulations for live practice
- "Onboarding Buddy": robot coach + mobile companion

RESEARCH

- HRI 2025 study: robot-led learners gained 17.3% proficiency
- Dyslexic learners saw bigger gains than typical peers
- Pain point: test scores don't capture real communication

WEAKNESS

- Anchor study is small-scale and short (90/40 participants, 5 days) so it’s weak at scale
- Real risk of over-reliance or feeling "rehearsed" instead of natural in actual conversations



hot girls study japanese

DESIGN OPPORTUNITIES

01 CONTEXT-AWARE LANGUAGE LEARNING

- Provide language support based on workplace situations.
- Adapt content for meetings, team lunches and casual conversations.
- Use mobile/context-aware interactions to provide relevant support when needed.

02 SOCIAL & COLLABORATIVE LEARNING

- Connect learners with coworkers or language buddies.
- Encourage real conversations and mutual learning.
- Create opportunities for learners to practise with others rather than learning in isolation.

03 LOW-PRESSURE CONVERSATION PRACTICE

- Allow users to rehearse conversations before interacting with coworkers.
- Provide a private, non-judgemental environment for making mistakes.
- Gradually build confidence before transitioning into real human interaction.



TARGET AUDIENCES

PEOPLE WITH ENGLISH AS AN ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

- Students who have moved to Australia or another country for study.
- May understand the language academically but struggle with everyday workplace communication.

RECENT GRADUATES OR NEW EMPLOYEES / WORKPLACE NEWCOMERS

- Need to understand workplace jargon, social norms and communication expectations.

Co-Lingo

Plan of Work



WHAT WE KNOW

- Non-judgmental practice > teacher-led for engaging those who dislike making mistakes
- Rehearsed fluency breaks under real pressure
- Buddy pairing reduces onboarding friction

WHAT WE NEED TO KNOW

- Does fear-of-first-attempt hold in real workplaces?
- Robot-only or app-only?
- Do nudges help or feel intrusive?
- At what point does the help become a crutch?

INTERVIEWS

- Group A - Non-language-speaking workers: early communication struggles, desired support
- Group B - Supporting workers/mentors: teaching burden, what they wish was pre-prepared
- Goal: Validate both sides through design concept

CONCEPT VALIDATION

- Robot-only vs. app-only, tested with participants
- Measure usefulness and naturalness
- Locks final direction

WIZARD-OF-OZ TEST

- Manual phrase nudge, 5 min pre-meeting
- Tests timing/feel before building

PROOF OF CONCEPT

- Build core interaction; simulate the rest
- Goal: Real user interaction get a sense of the whole system

TIMELINE

Weeks 5-6	Weeks 6-7	Weeks 7-9	Weeks 9-11	Weeks 11-12
Interviews, Concept validation, Finalise concept	Wizard-of-Oz, Refine from results	Build initial proof of concept prototype, Presentation	Refine from feedback, Small group testing	Finalise proof of concept, Final presentation